

Body hair

During the teen years, rising hormone levels in the body cause hair to darken and thicken. The color, texture, and amount of hair usually depends on a person's genetic makeup. Some people have lots of body hair, while others have less.

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The function of hair

Human hair has lots of different functions. The fine, light-colored hair that covers most of the body traps air to help humans regulate their body temperature. Hair on the head also allows the body to retain heat and helps protect the scalp, while hair around the eyes and in the nose protects these body parts from foreign objects entering. Pubic hair protects the genitals and may also play a part in attraction between males and females.

▽ Puberty changes

Hair grows in new places, and becomes darker and thicker in others. The color of body hair may be different to the hair on a teen's head.

